MARKETING AND SALES MANAGEMENT

Marketing has been defined in many different ways. This is the set of activities that directs the flow of goods and services from the producer to satisfy consumers and accomplish the objectives of the organization.

MARKETING

Marketing is the process by which individuals & groups obtain what they need and ~~what~~ want by creating and exchanging products & value with others. Marketing viewed in a larger perspective, are those activities devoted to;

1. Identifying specific markets for products and services,
2. Identifying existing and future needs and wants of these markets,
3. Guiding the development of products, packages, and services to fill these needs at a profit.
4. Selling, delivering and effecting legal transfer (or rights to the use) of these goods and services to the ultimate consumer or user.

Needs, Wants, Products

The most basic concept underlying marketing is that of human needs. Human needs are states of felt deprivation. Human needs are many and complex. These include basic physical needs for food, clothing, warmth and safety; social needs for belonging and affection; and individual needs for knowledge and self-expression. Marketers do not invent these needs; they are a basic part of human makeup. People in industrial society may try to find or develop objects that will satisfy their needs.

Wants are the form taken by human needs as they are shaped by culture and individual personality. Wants are described in terms of objects that will satisfy needs. A hungry person in Choma may want Nshima with Sour Milk to satisfy his need for food; however one form Lundazi may desire Nshima with Beans.

People satisfy their needs & wants with products. A product is anything that can be offered to a market to satisfy a need or want. It is anything capable of satisfying a need. It is anything that can be offered to a market for attention, acquisition, use or consumption that might satisfy a want or need. It includes;

- physical Objects
- Services
- Persons
- Places
- Ideas

Duties of a Marketing manager;

- Advising board of directors on marketing policy;
- Sales promotion- adverting, and display, pricing policy, discounts
- Control of distribution – this involves selection of channels of distribution, warehousing and transport facilities
- Marketing research – the marketing manager will keep the market under review, noting the extent of the market, the company's market share and the share of its competitors.
- Plan and execute all the activities for assessing and creating consumer demand and for the sale, storage and distribution of the company's goods.

MARKETING MANAGEMENT PHILOSOPHIES

Philosophies are the guides to marketing efforts undertaken by companies. Different companies may choose a particular philosophy to guide their marketing activities. There are five alternative concepts under which organisations conduct their marketing activities:

- *The Production Concept*

  This concept holds that consumers will favour products that are available and highly affordable. Thus the emphasis for management is on improving production and distribution efficiency.

  This concept is one of the oldest philosophies; it however may be useful in two situations. (1.) When demand for a product exceeds they supply – management's concern is to look for ways to increase their production. (2) When the product's cost is high –

management's goal is to look for ways to improve productivity so as to bring down the cost.

- *The Product Concept*
  The product concept holds that consumers will favour products that offer the most quality, and innovative features. Thus the organisation should devote its energies to making continuous product improvements.

  These managers assume that buyers admire well-made products and can appraise product quality and performance. These mangers are likely to suffer from Marketing Myopia – focusing on the product rather on the customer needs.

- *The Selling Concept*
  This concept holds that consumers will not buy enough of the organisation's product unless it undertakes a large – scale selling and promotion effort. The concept is typically practical with unsought goods – those that buyers do not normally think of buying such as encyclopaedias or insurance. Most firms practice the selling concept when the have overcapacity. Their aim is to sell what they make rather than what the market wants.

- *The Marketing Concept*
  This concept holds that achieving organisational goals depends on determining the needs and wants of target markets and delivering the desired satisfaction more effectively and efficiently than competitors do.

  The concept takes an outside – in kind of approach. It starts with a well-defined market, focuses on the customer needs, co-ordinates all the marketing activities affecting customers, and makes profits by creating long-term customer relationships based on customer value and satisfaction. Under this concept, companies produce what consumers' want, thereby satisfying consumers and making profits.

This concept is based on the premise that for a business to grow it must orient its activities towards fulfilling the needs and wants of its potential customers more effectively than its competitors. The consumer and his wants should become the fulcrum around which a business moves.

- *The Societal Marketing Concept*

  This concept holds that the organisation should determine the needs, wants and interest of target markets. It should then deliver superior value to customers in a way that maintains or improves the consumer's society's wellbeing. It is the newest philosophy. According to this concept, the pure marketing concept overlooks possible conflicts between short-run wants and consumers long-run welfare.

  For example, the Coca Cola Company, most people see it as a highly responsible corporation producing the soft drinks that satisfy consumer tastes. Yet some consumer can harm people's teeth, contains caffeine, and adds the litter problem with disposables bottles and cans.